Glossary/Dramatis Personae

Jacob Appelbaum	Hacker, cyber-libertarian, cryptography expert. Now living in Berlin.
Glenn Greenwald	Blogger and journalist, former trial lawyer. Fierce critic of American corporate and government wrongdoing. Now lives in Brazil.
Laura Poitras	Heiress, former chef, award-winning filmmaker. Now living in Berlin.
Edward Snowden	Former contractor for the NSA, who took up to 1.7m secret documents and fled to Russia.
CIA	America's Central Intelligence Agency. Responsible for human intelligence (HUMINT). Based in Langley, Virginia.
NSA	National Security Agency, responsible for collecting electronic intelligence. Based in Fort Meade, Maryland.
GCHQ	Government Communications Headquarters: Britain's counterpart to the NSA, based in Cheltenham.
FISC	Also known as the FISA court. Set up under the Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Act of 1978 to oversee the issuance of warrants for intelligence collection within the United States.
Meta-data	Details *about* a communication, but not involving its actual content. In a letter, for example, this would include the destination address on an envelope, the sender (if given), post-mark and stamp. For a mobile phone call, this would be the location of the device,